ERA 6

Jackson & Federal Power

1829 – 1838

The Bank War · the Nullification Crisis · Indian Removal

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did Andrew Jackson expand—and abuse—the power of the presidency?

KEY TERMS

Bank War · Nullification Crisis · Worcester v. Georgia · Indian Removal Act · Trail of Tears · spoils system

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 4.8 · AMSCO Ch. 4.8

A POWERFUL NEW PRESIDENCY

'King Andrew'?

Jackson Takes Power, 1829



- Thousands of ordinary citizens mobbed **Jackson**'s inauguration.
- He rewarded loyal supporters with government jobs—the **spoils system**.
- **Jackson** cast himself as the voice of the **common man**.

SECTION

The Bank War

Jackson vs. the Bank

- **Jackson** distrusted the **Second National Bank** as a tool of the wealthy elite.
- When Clay pushed an early recharter to trap him, **Jackson vetoed** it in 1832.
- He then pulled federal funds and placed them in state **'pet banks.'**



Killing the Bank

TRAP

Clay's Gambit

Clay pushes an early recharter to use against Jackson in 1832.

→

VETO

Jackson Strikes

Jackson vetoes the recharter as unconstitutional and elitist.

→

DRAIN

Pet Banks

He moves federal deposits into loyal state banks.

→

FALLOUT

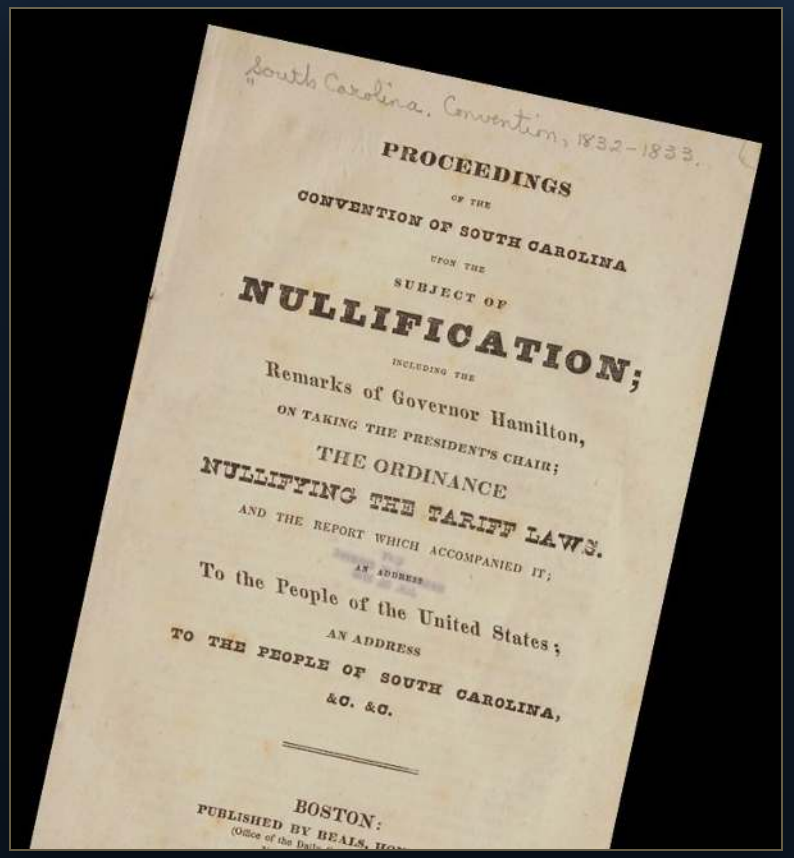
A Weakened Economy

The bank dies—helping set up the Panic of 1837.

SECTION

The Nullification Crisis

Nullification, 1832



- The **Tariff of Abominations** (1828) enraged the South.
- South Carolina declared it could **nullify**—void—the federal tariff.
- **Jackson**'s own VP, **John C. Calhoun**, championed nullification.

The Showdown

GRIEVANCE

The Tariff

High tariffs hurt the export-dependent South.

→

DEFIANCE

SC Nullifies

South Carolina declares the tariff null and void.

→

FORCE

Jackson Responds

Jackson threatens force—'disunion by armed force is treason.'

→

DEAL

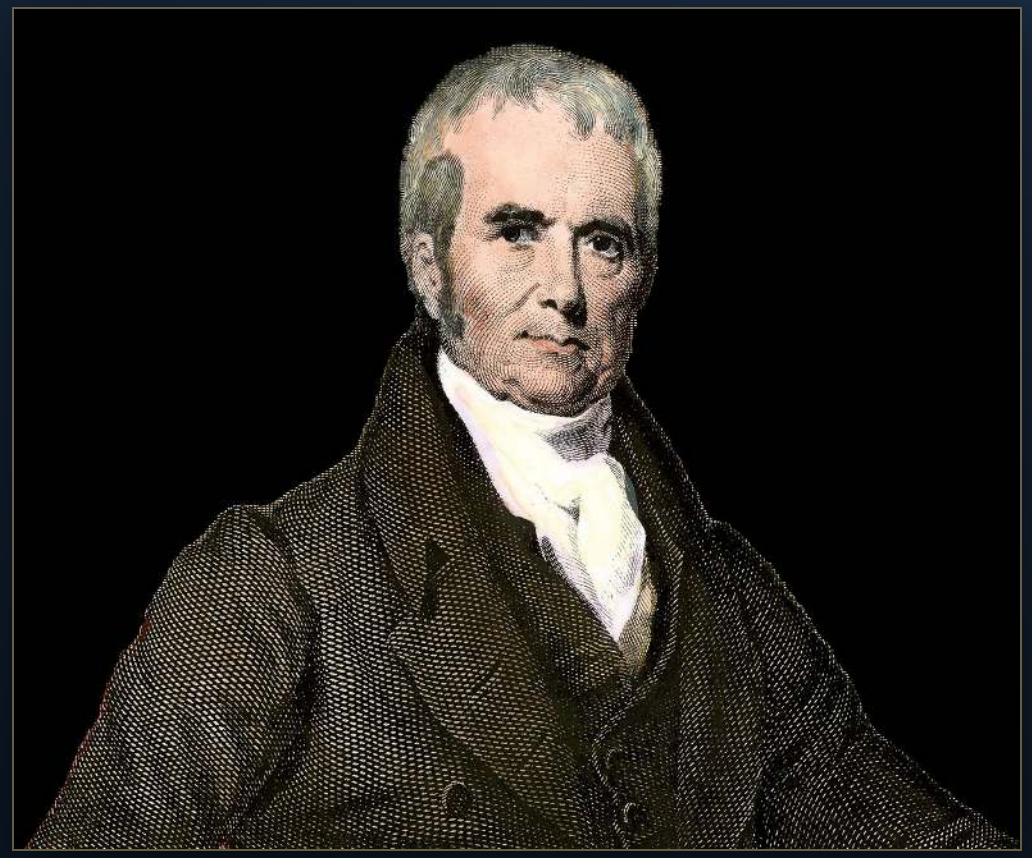
Clay's Compromise

A compromise tariff defuses the crisis—for now.

SECTION

Indian Removal

Worcester v. Georgia, 1832



- The **Cherokee** had adopted farming, a constitution, and a written language.
- In **Worcester v. Georgia**, **John Marshall**'s Court sided with the **Cherokee**.
- **Jackson** simply ignored it: 'Marshall has made his decision; now let him enforce it.'

The Trail of Tears

- The **Indian Removal Act** (1830) forced eastern tribes west of the Mississippi.
- In 1838, under Van Buren, the army marched the **Cherokee** to Oklahoma.
- Thousands died on the **Trail of Tears**.



The Power of 'King Andrew'

I

Rewarded Loyalists

Used the **spoils system** to fill the government.

II

Defied Congress & Court

Vetoed the bank; ignored **Worcester v. Georgia**.

III

Forced Removal

Drove Native nations west on the **Trail of Tears**.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Jackson & Federal Power

1. **Jackson** wielded presidential power boldly—destroying the **national bank** and expanding the **spoils system**.

2. The **Nullification Crisis** pitted state power against the Union; **Jackson** faced down South Carolina.

3. Despite the **Cherokee**'s Supreme Court victory in **Worcester v. Georgia**, **Jackson**'s **Indian Removal** forced them west on the deadly **Trail of Tears**.

DISCUSS & APPLY

Jackson & Federal Power

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain how Jackson's **veto of the national bank** reflected his vision of presidential power.

ARGUMENTATION

Critics called him **'King Andrew.'** Using today's evidence, make a claim: did Jackson abuse the power of the presidency?

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

How did the treatment of the **Cherokee**—despite winning at the Supreme Court—reveal the limits of law in Jacksonian America?

Up next — **Lesson 15: The Second Party System** (Whigs & the Panic of 1837)